

Dichotomy: there are exactly two states in the afterlife, heaven and hell.

Non-universality: some
people go to heaven,
and some to hell.

Divine control: it is up
to God who goes to heaven
and who goes to hell.

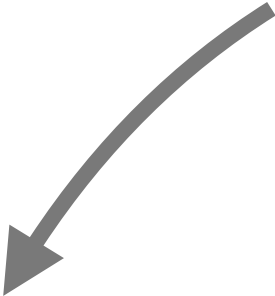
Proportionality: justice is proportional, in the sense that it “prohibits very unequal treatment of persons who are very similar in relevant respects.”

By Non-universality and Divine control, it follows that God decides that some people - call them group A - go to heaven and that some other people - group B - go to hell. By Badness, it follows that group A is much better off than group B. By Dichotomy, it follows that every human being is either in group A or group B. By Proportionality (given that the people in group A are much, much better off than the ones in group B), it follows that if God is just, there must be some way of dividing people into groups A and B which does not place people who are relevantly very similar into different groups. So by Justice, it follows that there must be some way of dividing people into groups A and B which does not place people who are relevantly very similar into different groups.

Justice: God's judgement about who goes to heaven & hell is just.

God sends some people
(group A) to heaven
and everyone else
(group B) to hell.





Let's try to lay out Sider's reasoning by isolating the various features of the **traditional doctrine** of heaven and hell that he thinks are inconsistent with the existence of a perfectly good God.

“A certain traditional conception of the afterlife is *binary*. After death one proceeds either to heaven or hell. Heaven is very, very good; hell is very, very bad. There are no possibilities for the afterlife other than heaven and hell, and membership in heaven or hell is never indeterminate or a matter of degree. The problem with the binary conception is that it contradicts God's justice. God must employ some criterion to decide who goes to heaven and who goes to hell. No reasonable criterion would be sharp; any reasonable criterion will have borderline cases. But the binary conception of the afterlife allows for no corresponding fuzziness in how the dead are to be treated. Hell must therefore contain people who are nearly indiscernible in relevant respects from people in Heaven. No just God would allow such a monstrously unfair thing.”

It is part of the traditional doctrine that God decides whether people go to heaven and hell based on certain properties of those people. We will leave open for now what those properties might be; just to have a name for them, let's call them the **relevant properties**.

Dichotomy: there are exactly two states in the afterlife, heaven and hell.





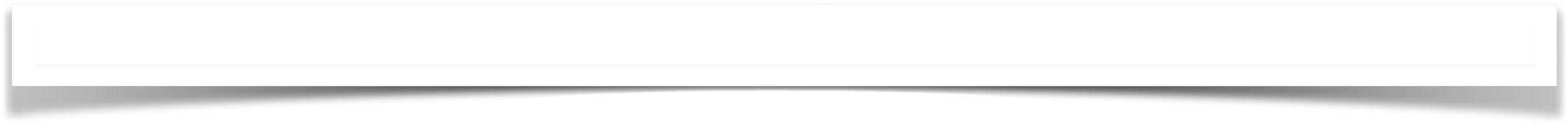
the
paradox of
heaven and
hell



replies to the
paradox



evil & lives
not worth
living



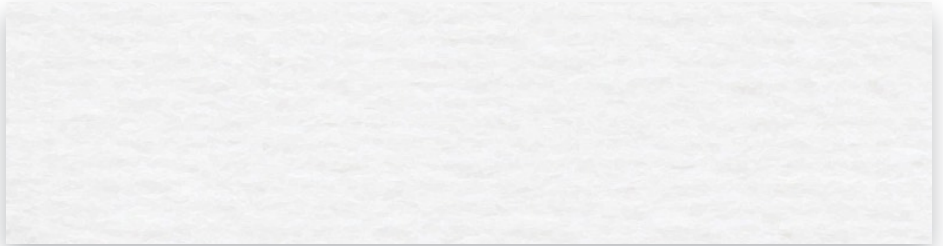
Dichotomy: there are exactly two states in the afterlife, heaven and hell.



Non-invertibility: some

people go to heaven;

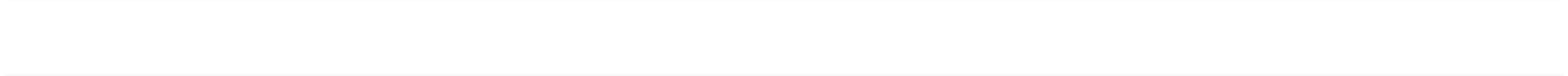
and some here.



and who goes to hell.

to God who goes to heaven

Divine child: it is up



very similar in relevant respects.”

Proportionality: justice is proportional, in the sense that it 'prohibits very unequal treatment of persons who are

some other people-group B-go to hell. By Dichotomy, it follows that group A is much better than group B. By Dichotomy, it

follows that every human being is either in group A or group B. By Propriety (given that the people in group A are much, much

which not place people who are relevantly similar into different groups. So by justice, it follows that there must be some

better off than the ones in group B), it follows that if God is just, there must be way of dividing people into group A and B

By Non-universality and Divine control, it follows that God decides that some people - call them group A - go to heaven and that

way of dividing people into groups A and B which do not place people who are relevantly very similar into different groups

Justice: God's judgement about what goes to heaven & hell is just.



God sends some people

(group A) to heaven

and every one else

(group B) to hell.

the existence of a perfectly good God.

traditional doctrine of heaven and hell that he thinks are inconsistent with

Let's try to lay out Sider's reasoning by isolating the various features of the

It is part of the tradition that God decides whether people go to

Let's call them the relevant properties.

pen for what those parties might be; just have a name for them,

heaven and hell based on certain properties of those people. We will have



Didn't only: there are

afterlife, heaven and

ne

1

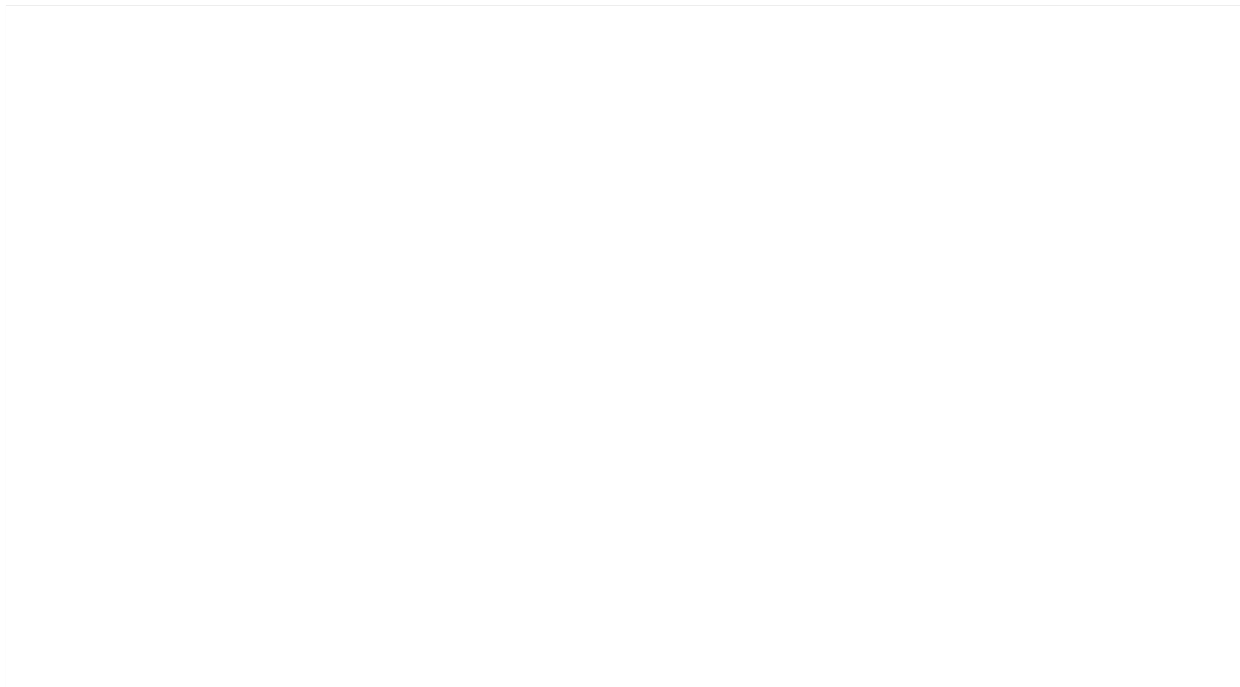
1



exactly two states in the

describes the kind of view wanted to discuss:

The following passage from the Catechism of the Catholic Church



all the nations, and he will separate them one from

just and the unjust,' will precede the Last

eternis in die !!

Judgment. Christ will come "in his glory, and all

but the goats at the left.... and they will go away

the angels with him... Before him will be gathered

into external punishment, but the rights into

another as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

1038. The resurrection of all the dead, 'of both the

goats, and he will place the sheep at his right hand,

One topic often associated with belief in God is the topic of life after death.

Our first question today is: what we are told about life after death by

many of the major monotheistic religions compatible with the existence of a

perfectly good Good?



1038. The resurrection of the dead, "of

the Last Judgment. . . Christ will come "in

right hand, but the goat at the left... and

they will go away into eternal punishment,

this glory, and all the angels with him.

and the wild sheep are then from another

both the just and the unjust," will proceed

Before him will be gathered all the nations,

as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

goats, and the wild prairie sheep at his

but the rights are all in it.

This certainly seems like a picture according to which, after death, God passes

judgement on all of us, and on the basis of our life, decides that some of us will

got to heaven forever, and some others to hell forever. (If not 'forever', then the

talk of the last judgment wouldn't make much sense.)

Turned-in showed why it is plausible that respo to the argument from evil

view of life after death we get here on pain of being perfectly good?

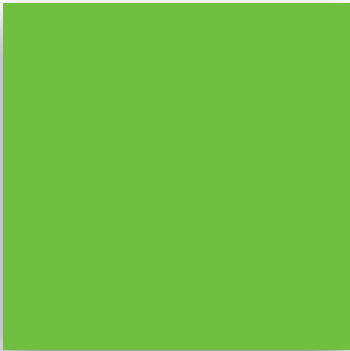
must depend on the possibility of life after death. We will now ask: is the kind of



the
paradox of
heaven and
hell



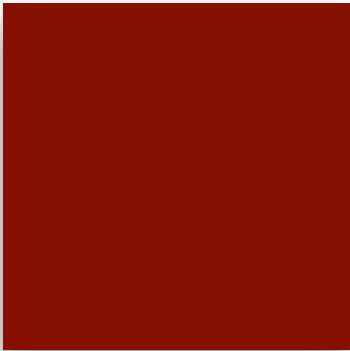












seems to give the defender of the afterlife further main options.



It seems difficult to deny Justice, Badness, or Divine Control. So that





Let's try to layout Sider's reasoning by isolating the various features of the

the existence of a perfectly good God.

traditional doctrine of heaven and hell that he thinks are inconsistent with

It is part of the traditional doctrine that God decides whether people go to

Let's call them the relevant properties.

heaven and hell based on certain properties of these people. We will have

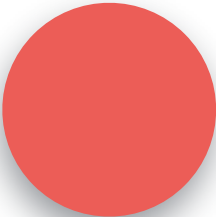
open for what those properties might be; just have a name for them,





A solid red circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing white text.

evil & lives
not worth
living



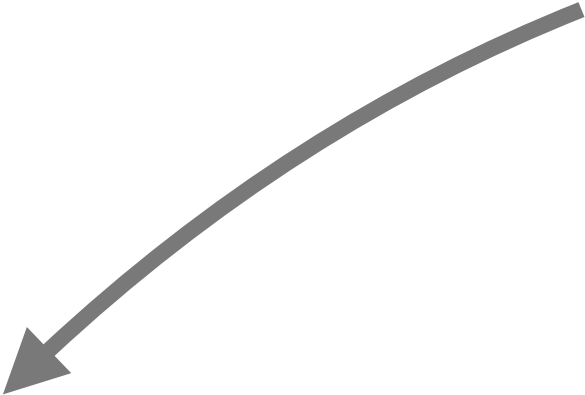
Non-universality: some
people go to heaven,
and some to hell.



Divine control: it is up
to God who goes to heaven
and who goes to hell.

God sends some people
(group A) to heaven
and everyone else
(group B) to hell.







Dichotomy: there are
exactly two states in the
afterlife, heaven and
hell.



Non-universality: some
people go to heaven,
and some to hell.

Divine control: it is up
to God who goes to heaven
and who goes to hell.

God sends some people
(group A) to heaven
and everyone else
(group B) to hell.

Dichotomy: there are
exactly two states in the
afterlife, heaven and
hell.



the
paradox of
heaven and
hell



replies to the
paradox



evil & lives
not worth
living